

LEAKED EMAIL PROMPTS ACCUSATIONS OF CHEATING TOWARD LATE LEGEND NATHAN LAPALMA

Post-mortem exclusive back-channel emails hint at larger conspiracy

by Kingston Lee

An avalanche of astonishment has descended over the small mountain town of Three Pines, Colo. as, in the wake of the shocking murder of legendary figure skater and coach Nathan LaPalma, an email has leaked that suggests the titan's participation in cheating and corruption within the American Skating Association.

The email, which was provided to the press by an anonymous source close to LaPalma, contains what appears to be a half-hearted confession of ill-doing with regards to the now-canceled ASA national tournament.

In light of this new information, speculation has erupted among fans online as to the details of this alleged ill-doing, with many coming to the consensus that LaPalma may have conspired with

one of the individuals police initially suspected in LaPalma's sudden death.

Lillian Varma, a student of LaPalma's, had this to say: "I have trained literally every day of my life to master the art of skating. I would never ever cheat in a million years!"

LaPalma protege Harrison Campbell's manager released the following official statement in the wake of the news.

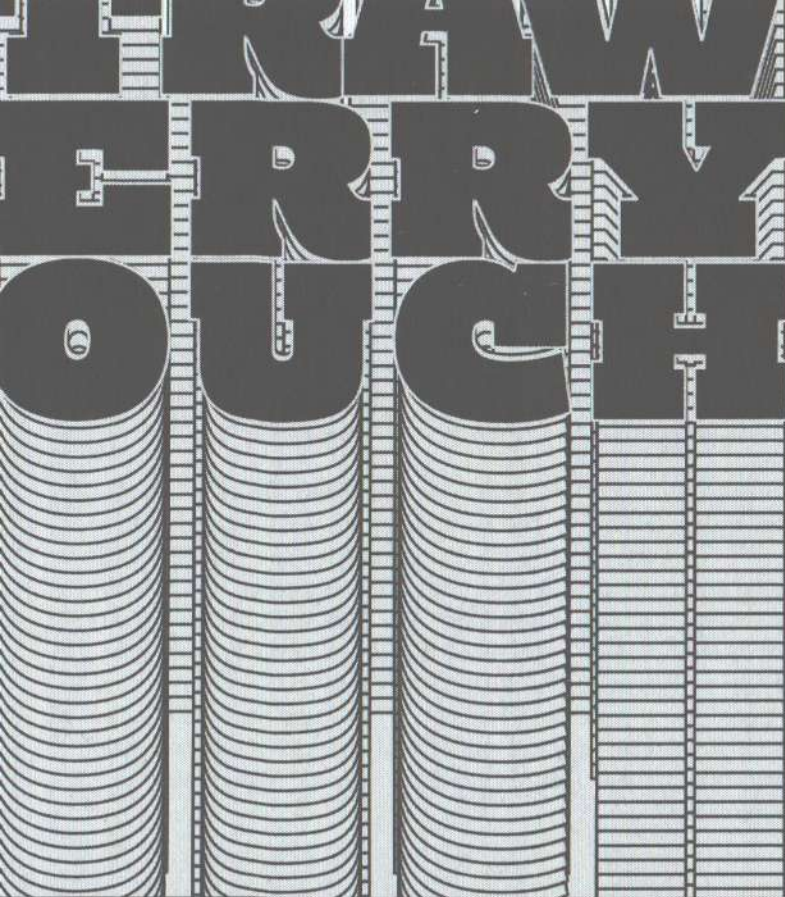
"Harrison Campbell prizes sportsmanship and integrity. Harrison Campbell did not, nor did anyone on his team, have any knowledge of behavior taking place that violated ASA rules and guidelines."

Fellow coach and retired skater Marcus Lourdes said, "With all due respect to the deceased, I'm above cheating. LaPalma was the kind of person to fight for his students. Perhaps he let that admirable drive take him down a dark path."

"Perhaps he felt as though his newest student wouldn't be able to succeed by conventional means, but was unwilling to admit that to himself," Lourdes added. "Either way, this is a tragic and disturbing revelation. I hope the skating community will grow past it in time."

When asked for comment, Carol Donnelly, acting in her capacity as an ASA administrative official, said, "I can assure you that the ASA will perform its due diligence regarding these very serious accusations. As Nathan LaPalma's dear friend, I will name this inquiry exactly what it is: tasteless muckraking."

Donnelly went on to note that the ASA has launched an official internal probe into the allegations of LaPalma's potential corruption.



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